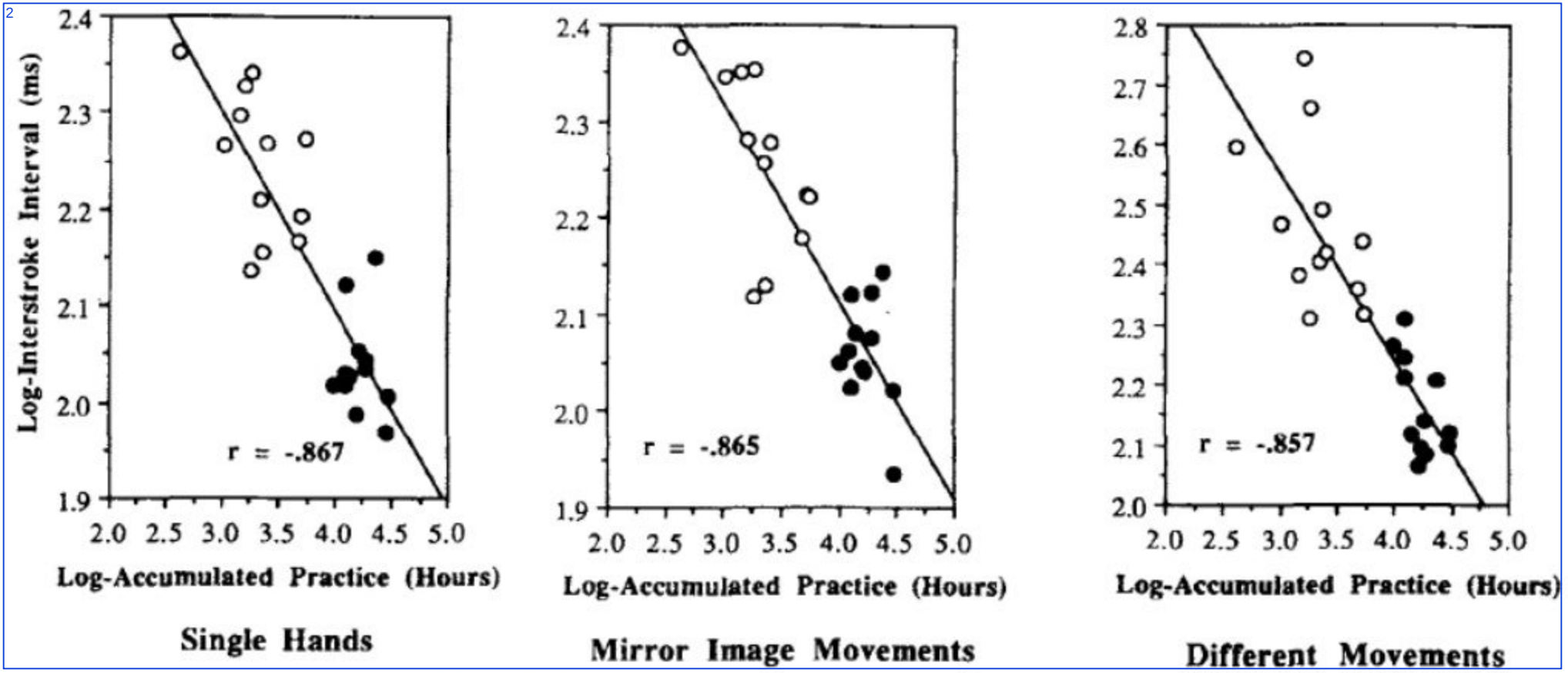
Core physical ability differences reflect accumulated practice



Experts are dark circles. Amateurs are empty circles.

Ericsson (U. Colorado), Krampe, Tesche-Romer (Max Plank Institute - Berlin), 1993, The role of deliberate practice in the acquisition of expert performance, *Psychological Review,* 100, p. 385

Focus v. variety in medical skills

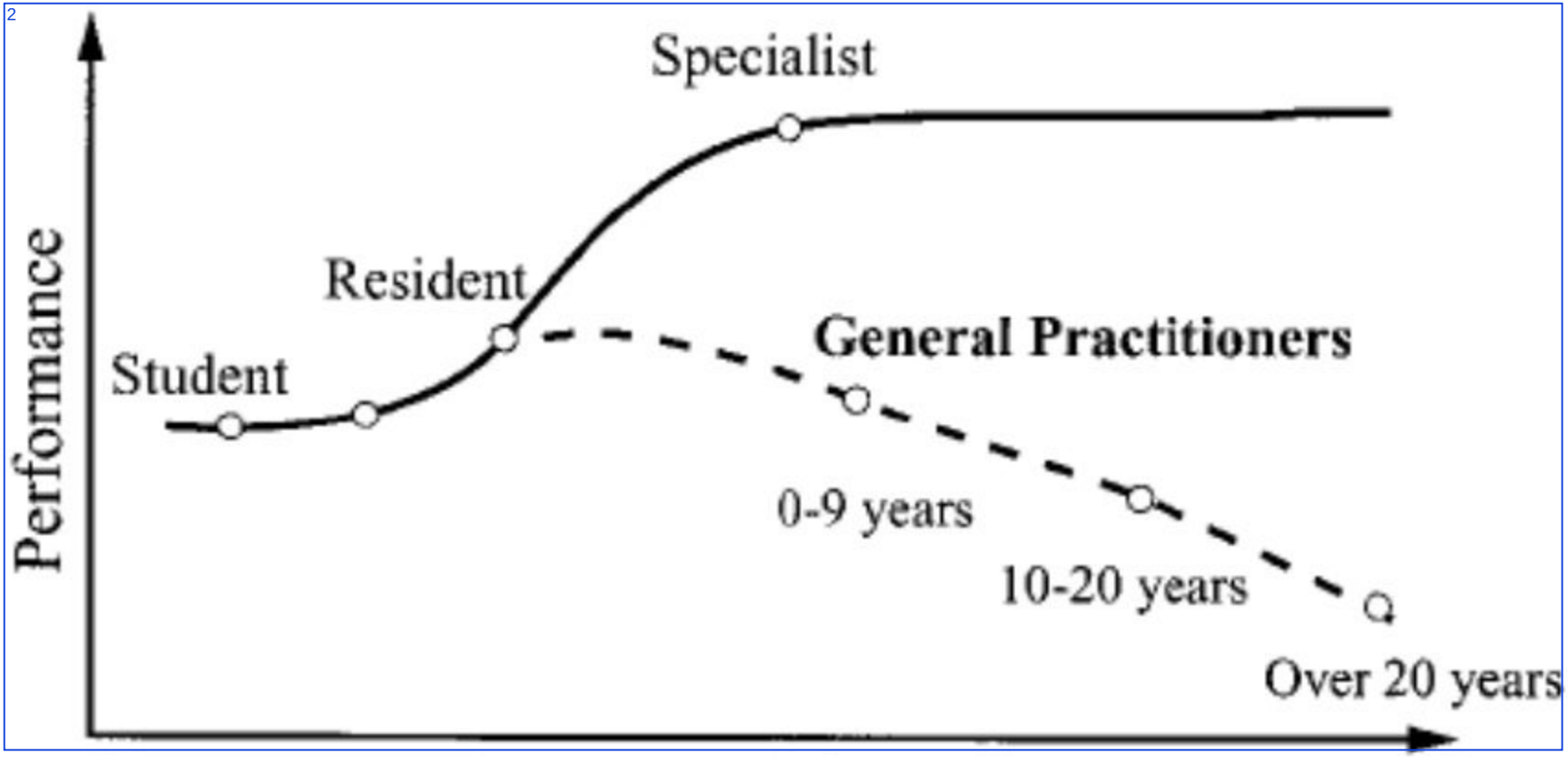
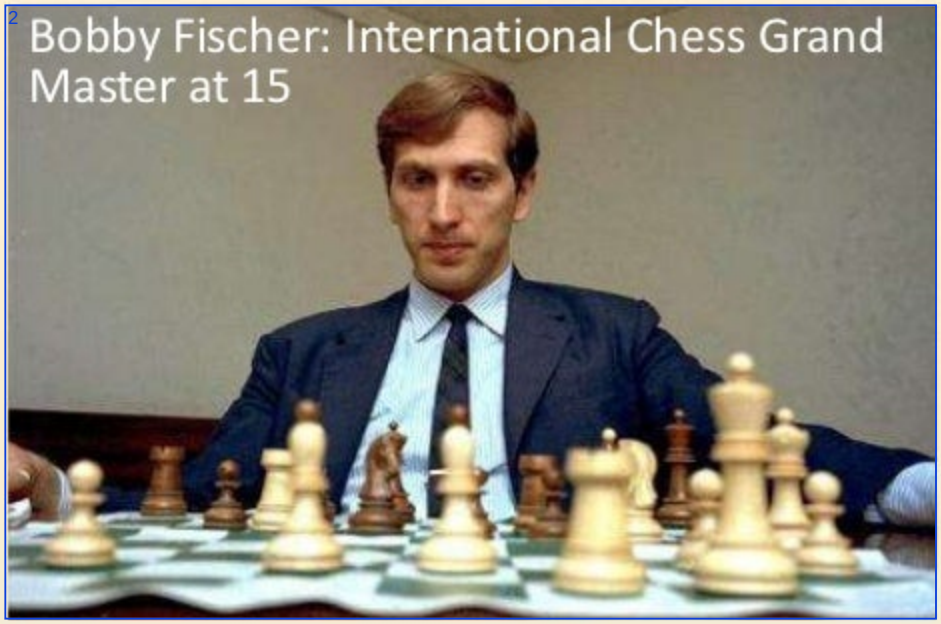


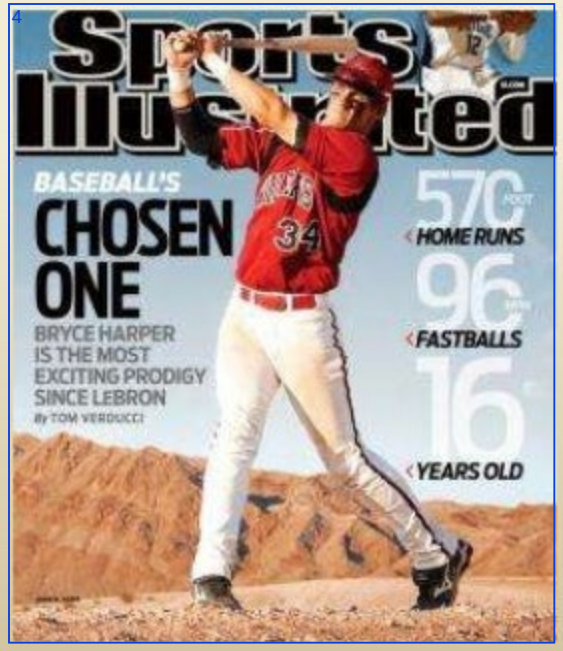
Figure 4. Two trends for development of medical performance as a function of experience and instruction.

Butterworth, J. (NYU), Reppert, E. (NYU), 1960, Auscultatory acumen in the general medical population. *Journal of the American Medical Association*, *174*, 32–34. Graph from Ericsson, K. A. (Florida State U.), 2004, Deliberate practice and the acquisition and maintenance of expert performance in medicine and related disciplines. *Academic Medicine, 79*, S70-S81

What about young phenoms and child prodigies?









Bryce Harper:

- 16 yr. old baseball phenom
- Longest distance home run ever hit at Tropicana Field
- 570 ft home run during a high school game at age 15